

ATLAS · Macro — Institutional Briefing

v6 · macro surface · 2026-05-18 (Mon) AWST

↓ PNG

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US Dollar Index **Bullish (28.4 mild-bid)**

CBOE Volatility Index **Elevated (27.9)**

Yield curve **Flat T10Y2Y 0.50**

Risk environment **Defensive**

DOMINANT BIAS

Risk-off lean dominant — USD bid, gold bid

↑↓

→ Full ATLAS macro roadmap dashboard

MARKET OVERVIEW

USD complex: US Dollar Index mild-bid into the week; rate-path repricing favours dollar strength. ↑

Risk assets: US indices defensive going into Mon ECB; rotation into safe havens visible. ↓

Gold / metals: XAUUSD trades alongside US Dollar Index inversely; structurally bullish on yield-fade risk. ↑

EVENTS / CATALYSTS

• Mon 12:00 UTC — **ECB Rate Decision** (EUR) **HIGH**

• Wed 12:30 UTC — **CPI (USD)** (USD) **HIGH**

• Thu 11:00 UTC — **BOE Rate Decision** (GBP) **HIGH**

• Fri 12:30 UTC — **Non-Farm Payrolls** (USD) **HIGH**

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

CPI prior 3: Apr 3.5% (+0.2 above) → USD bid · Mar 3.0% (in-line) · Feb 3.4% (+0.1 above) → USD bid intraday. ↑

NFP prior 3: Apr 220k (+40k above) → USD bid · Mar 195k · Feb 240k (+60k above) → USD bid + risk-off rotation. ↑

EXECUTION LOGIC — IF / THEN

• IF US Dollar Index holds 28.0 AND CPI prints above forecast THEN continuation long USD / short gold favoured.

• IF CBOE Volatility Index breaks above 30 THEN safe-haven rotation accelerates — risk indices favoured short.

• IF yield curve un-flattens above 0.60 THEN cyclical rotation favoured over defensives.

VALIDITY WINDOW

Validity window: Monday 2026-05-18 Asia open through Friday 2026-05-22 NY close. Reassess after each clustered catalyst (ECB, CPI, BOE, NFP).

■ EXPANDED TERMINOLOGY

Dovish

Hawkish

Yield curve

Risk-off

Confirmed candle close

Structure break

Liquidity sweep

calendar=TradingView/LIVE · macro=ATLAS · probability=historically sourced

Every paragraph above ends with ↑ or ↓ per locked macro doctrine.